

Sentinel 3D — Getting Started

3D security site planning · installation, activation and first steps · version 4.1.0

1. System requirements

	Minimum	Recommended
Operating system	Windows 10 (64-bit) or macOS 11 Big Sur	Windows 11, or macOS 13 Ventura or later
Processor	Intel Core i5 / AMD Ryzen 5 (2016 or newer), or Apple M1	Intel Core i7 / AMD Ryzen 7, or Apple M2 or newer
Memory (RAM)	8 GB	16 GB or more
Graphics	Built-in graphics with WebGL 2 (Intel UHD 620, AMD Vega, Apple M1)	Dedicated graphics with 4 GB (NVIDIA GTX 1650 / RTX, AMD RX 6000) or Apple M-series
Screen	1366 × 768	1920 × 1080 or larger
Free disk space	1 GB	5 GB on an SSD (room for projects and aerial photos)
Internet	Not needed to use the software	Only for updates; nothing else ever goes online
Input	Mouse or trackpad	Mouse with scroll wheel

Large sites with many buildings, the “3 views” comparison and **High quality** shadows need the recommended graphics. On older computers choose **Settings → Picture quality → Fast (older devices)**.

2. Install on Windows

1. Download **Sentinel-3D-Setup-x.x.x.exe** from the link your supplier gave you.
2. Double-click it. If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”, click **More info → Run anyway**. (This appears because the installer is new to Windows, not because anything is wrong.)
3. Read and accept the licence agreement.
4. Choose **who to install for** and the **folder** (the suggested folder is fine), then click **Install**.
5. Leave **Run Sentinel 3D** ticked and click **Finish**. A desktop shortcut and a Start-menu entry are created.

3. Install on a Mac

1. Download **Sentinel-3D-x.x.x-mac.dmg** and double-click it.

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2. Drag the **Sentinel 3D** icon onto the **Applications** folder, then eject the disk image.
3. The first time only: open **Applications**, **right-click** Sentinel 3D and choose **Open**, then **Open** again.
4. If macOS says it cannot verify the app: open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway** next to Sentinel 3D.

4. Activate with your licence key

Sentinel 3D works only after it is activated. **Each licence key works on one computer only.**

1. Open Sentinel 3D. The **Product Activation** screen shows your **Machine Code** (for example `TNXL-BY89-STSD-9CXS-5EZH-3B`).
2. Press **Copy** and send the code to your supplier by WhatsApp or email.
3. You receive a licence key (a long line starting with `S3D1.`) or a `.s3dkey` file.
4. Paste the whole key into the box — or press **Open key file…** — and press **Activate**.
5. Press **Start Sentinel 3D**. You will not be asked again on this computer.

Message	What to do
“This key was made for a different computer”	Send the Machine Code shown on this computer to your supplier.
“This key is not genuine, or part of it is missing”	Copy the whole key again — every character, from S3D1. to the end.
“This licence has expired”	Contact your supplier for a renewal key. Your projects are kept safe.
“The computer’s date appears to have been set back”	Correct the date and time in your computer settings.
New computer, or Windows/macOS reinstalled	The Machine Code changes. Ask your supplier for a new key.

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5. Learn with the demo site

On the start screen press **Open the demo site**. It is a complete invented site — a hotel, an embassy compound, a data centre, power and water plants, an airport terminal, a hospital, a mall, a stadium and homes — containing **every building type and every security item**, including underground pipes, tunnels and basements. The **Demo site tour** (it starts by itself, or Help → Demo site tour) flies round the site and switches on each tool in turn.

6. Your first project

1. On the start screen choose **New project**. Give it a name and the site's width and depth in metres.
2. Optional: add a **background photo from above** (drone or satellite picture) so you can trace the real site.
3. Drag buildings and security items from the **Add** panel onto the model — they stick to the ground, to walls and to roofs. There are 70 building types in 9 sectors (hotels, corporate, government and diplomatic, critical infrastructure, health and education, industry, residential and more) and over 90 security items. Drag things to move them; use the handles to turn and resize.
4. Use the **Security** and **Analyse** tabs for camera coverage, blind spots, weapon and observation arcs, dead ground, night lighting, response times and the security report.
5. Press **Save** (Ctrl+S / ⌘S). Use **Help → Guided tour** for a walk through every feature.

7. Underground planning

- Press **U** (or Security → **Underground**) to make the ground see-through.
- Set **Basement levels** (B1–B3) and their use on any building in its properties.
- Use **Add underground…** or the Underground section of the Add panel to place tanks, manholes, bunkers, underground car parks and air intakes, and to draw sewers, storm drains, culverts, cable trenches, water mains, service tunnels and suspected tunnels.
- Mark pipes and vents as **protected** (grille, bars or sensor) and manholes as **locked**. The security report lists every underground weakness, such as a crawlable drain under the boundary wall.

8. Keep your work protected

- **Sign-in protection** (Settings → Security): every saved project on the computer is encrypted (AES-256). Nobody can open them without signing in.
- **Users and roles**: the Administrator adds people as **Planner** (build, save, export, print) or **Viewer** (look only). The **Activity log** records who signed in, saved, exported, printed or deleted, and failed sign-in attempts.
- **Touch ID** (Macs with a fingerprint sensor) and a **PIN** give quick unlock; your password always works too. Five wrong PINs switch the PIN off.
- **Auto-lock** after a set idle time, and **Lock now** when you step away.
- **Protected project files (.s3d)**: send a project to someone else encrypted with its own password.

If a password is forgotten, encrypted projects **cannot be recovered** — not even by the supplier. Another Administrator can set a new password for a user. Keep exported backups.

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9. Backups

- Use **File → Export to a file** (or **Export protected file**) regularly and keep copies on a USB drive or another computer.
- Projects are stored inside your user account on this computer. Uninstalling the app does **not** delete them.
- **Versions** keeps earlier saved states of each project so you can compare or go back.

10. Updates

- **Windows**: when the computer is online, Sentinel 3D downloads updates in the background and asks to restart. Save your work and press **Restart and update now**.
- **Mac**: choose **Sentinel 3D → Check for Updates…**. The download page opens; replace the app in Applications with the new one. Your projects and licence are kept.

11. Uninstall

- **Windows**: Settings → Apps → Sentinel 3D → Uninstall.
- **Mac**: drag Sentinel 3D from Applications to the Bin.
- Your licence stays on the computer, so reinstalling on the same computer does not need a new key.

12. If something goes wrong

Problem	Try this
3D view is blank, black or very slow	Update the graphics driver. Choose Settings → Picture quality → Fast (older devices). Close other heavy programs.
Buttons or labels look cut off	Make the window larger, or use View → Panels to hide the side panels.
Windows SmartScreen or macOS blocks the app	See sections 2 and 3: “More info → Run anyway”, or “Privacy & Security → Open Anyway”.
Forgot the sign-in password	Ask another Administrator to set a new one. Otherwise use “Forgot the password?” to erase and start again (exported files are not affected).
Anything else	Contact your supplier with the version number (Help → About) and your Licence number (Settings → Licence).

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